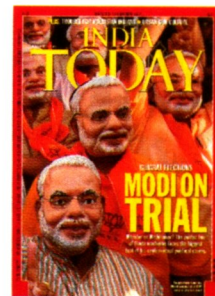


SHAILESH RAVAL



"Modi on Trial",
December 17, 2007

"Finally, here is an article that has presented an unbiased picture of Modi's personality and his way of governance."

MILIND JADHAV, *Belgaum*

The Rise of Moditva

With a spate of unseemly accusations and controversies bedevilling the Gujarat elections, it is the image of the Indian polity that would suffer most, irrespective of who or which party wins ("The Cult of Modi", December 17).

S.C. KAPOOR, *Noida*

The story reveals Narendra Modi's graduation from a unidirectional Hindutva brand to a dynamic Hindu leader. Even if he loses the election, it would not be the end of Moditva. He has arrived on the national political scene in a big way.

AMITAV MISHRA, *Bhubaneswar*

As the fourth estate, media is expected to take a balanced view in its reporting. Somehow in Gujarat's case, both the print and the electronic media have lost their unbiased approach and stuck to Modi-bashing—a

poor example for future journalists.

K. VENKATARAMAN, *Mumbai*

The story mentions that Modi will receive high marks if development alone were the criterion. Unfortunately, issues of communalism and corruption usually take precedence in Indian politics and development the backseat.

ANJUM M. SAMEL, *Mumbai*

Modi fancies himself as the sole custodian of Gujarati pride and has no respect for his own party. He is trying to polarise the voters while the development plank—on which the election was supposed to be fought earlier—has somehow got lost.

D.B.N. MURTHY, *Bangalore*

Modi being able to encash his infamy is no big deal. After all, Ramesh Sippy's *Sholay* owes its success to Gabbar Singh, not Jai and Veeru.

RAJNEESH BATRA, *Delhi*

The Struggle Continues

It is good to see Malaysians of Indian origin gathering courage to agitate against the discrimination meted out to them by their Government ("Fighting for Identity", December 17). India must come out strongly in their support.

S. LAKSHMI, *on e-mail*

The undue harshness of the Malaysian regime on Hindraf members is in stark contrast to India's undue interest in protecting the minorities, even at the cost of national security. India is the only place where minorities are treated like gods while in other countries, they are treated like dogs.

V.S. GANESHAN, *Bangalore*

The country should discreetly revise its trade relations with those that discriminate against people of Indian origin.

A. SURESH, *on e-mail*

Arms and the Nation

The Government should not give in to Russia's blackmail ("Battle over Gorshkov", December 17). If the current impasse over the deal continues, it should recover its advance money with the penalty.

MADHU AGRAWAL, *Delhi*

Unhealthy Ministry

It was a mistake to appoint Anbumani Ramadoss as the health minister ("Fight to the Finish", December 17). Ever since he took over, he has done nothing much except fight a futile war with AIIMS director Venugopal apart from a few "cosmetic surgeries" in the form of campaigns for pictorial warnings on cigarette packets. He should concentrate on doing some real work like improving the conditions of government hospitals, most of which are in a mess.

ABHILASH THADHANI, *Ahmedabad*